



**Patna powerhouse:** With 316 raid points and nerves of steel, Ayan Lohchab became the heartbeat of Patna's resurgence in Season 12.

PKL MEDIA

big name in Iranian kabaddi. It wasn't just the youngsters who shone; experienced campaigners like Bharat Hooda and Vijay Malik also stood out.

#### **Moments of magic**

Season 12 also produced moments of sheer brilliance, such as Bulls' Shubham Bitke's historic seven-point raid against Patna Pirates. Even teams that missed the knockout stage in previous seasons, like Telugu Titans, experienced moments of redemption by ending their long playoff drought.

#### **Controversies that shook the mat**

Despite the on-mat heroics, the season was also marred by controversies. The biggest shock came when Tamil Thalaivas sent home its star player, Pawan Sehrawat, after just three matches for an undisclosed breach of team rules. The Indian national team captain later took to social media, claiming that a member of the

management was "calling all the shots." Later in the season, coach Sanjeev Balyan and captain Arjun Deshwal echoed similar concerns in a press conference. The Thalaivas managed only six wins from 18 league matches and failed to reach the knockouts.

Similarly, captain Ankush Rathee's sudden exit from the Bengaluru Bulls sparked speculation about internal conflicts.

But the deepest frustration centred on refereeing decisions throughout the season. The peak of this discontent came during the Dabang Delhi versus Haryana Steelers clash, where a disputed time-stoppage ruling allegedly denied Haryana a final raid, resulting in a narrow 38-37 loss. The frustration was evident as Steelers players, in an unprecedented gesture, refused to shake hands with their Delhi counterparts after the final whistle.

PKL Season 12 was suffocating in its intensity, fulfilling the promise of the new format. As the league enters its teenage years, a new era of the ancient sport is dawning. With athletes getting increasingly professional, it is high time for the teams and the league to follow suit.

## Roll of fame



#### **Most Raid Points:**

Ayan Lohchab — 316 in 22 matches (Patna Pirates)

#### **Most Tackle Points:**

Navdeep — 73 in 21 matches (Patna Pirates)

#### **Most Super 10s:**

Ayan Lohchab — 16 in 22 matches (Patna Pirates)

#### **Most High 5s:**

Jaideep Dahiya — 7 in 19 matches (Haryana Steelers)

#### **Most Super Raids:**

Ayan Lohchab — 9 in 22 matches (Patna Pirates)

#### **Most Super Tackles:**

Jaideep Dahiya — 13 in 19 matches (Haryana Steelers)

#### **Most Do-or-die Raid Points:**

Ayan Lohchab — 39 in 22 matches (Patna Pirates)

## Award winners



#### **Most Valuable Player (MVP) of the season:**

Fazel Atrachali (Dabang Delhi)

#### **Raider of the season:**

Ayan Lohchab (Patna Pirates)

#### **Defender of the season:**

Navdeep (Patna Pirates)

#### **New Young Player (NYP) of the season:**

Deepak Sankar (Bengaluru Bulls)